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OECD
ECONOMIC SURVEYS

ORGANISATION FOR ECONOMIC CO-OPERATION AND DEVELOPMENT

NORWAY

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RETOUR DIFFÉRÉ

ORGANISATION DE COOPÉRATION ET DE DÉVELOPPEMENT ÉCONOMIQUES

JUNE 1968

BASIC STATISTICS OF NORWAY

THE LAND

Area (1 000 sq.km)	324
Arable area (1 000 sq.km)	10
Productive forest (1 000 sq.km)	70
Major cities (January 1968):	
Oslo	484 300
Bergen	116 800

THE PEOPLE

Population (Jan. 1968)	3 802 000
No. of inhabitants per sq.km	12
Net natural increase annual rate (average 1960-67)	29 500
Per 1 000 inhabitants (average 1960-67)	8.0
Labour force total, 1967 (man years)	1 552 500
Of which, in agriculture, forestry and fishing	278 200
Net annual migration (average 1960-67)	—15

PRODUCTION

Gross National Product in 1967 (millions of Kr. OECD definition)	59 459
GNP per head (US $)	2 190
Gross fixed capital formation (1967):	
Percentage of the GNP	31
Per head US $	680

THE GOVERNMENT

Public consumption in 1967 (percentage of GNP)	13
General government current revenue in 1967 (percentage of GNP)	34
Public gross fixed capital formation in 1967- (percentage of GNP)	10
Composition of Parliament (No. of seats):	
Labour party	68
Conservative party	31
Centre (Agrarian) party	18
Liberal party	18
Christian Democrats	13
Left-wing Socialist party	2
	150

Last general election: 1965.

Next general election: 1969.

LIVING STANDARDS

Average hourly earnings of male industrial workers in 1967 (in kroner)	10.39
No. of passenger cars in use per 1,000 inhabitants (Dec. 1967)	150
No. of telephones per 1 000 inhabitants (Dec. 1967)	260
No. of radio licences per 1 000 inhabitants (Dec. 1967)	295
No. of television licences per 1 000 inhabitants (Dec. 1967)	174

FOREIGN TRADE

Exports:	
Exports of goods and services as a percentage of GNP (average 1960-1967)	37
Of which:	
Gross freight earnings	15
Main exports in 1967 (percentage of total commodity exports):	
Base metals and products thereof	26
Forestry products	14
Fish and fish products	9
Machinery, apparatus and transport equipment (excl. ships)	12
Imports:	
Imports of goods and services as a percentage of GNP (average 1960-67)	38
Main imports in 1967 (percentage of total commodity imports):	
Ships (average 1960-67)	16
Machinery, apparatus and transport equipment (excl. ships)	28
Raw materials (non-edible) incl. fuels and chemicals	22
Base metals and products thereof	12

THE CURRENCY

Monetary unit: Krone.

Currency unit per US $ 7.14

OECD ECONOMIC SURVEYS

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ORGANISATION FOR ECONOMIC CO-OPERATION AND DEVELOPMENT

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development was set up under a Convention signed in Paris on 14th December 1960 by the Member countries of the Organisation for European Economic Co-operation and by Canada and the United States. This Convention provides that the OECD shall promote policies designed:

- *to achieve the highest sustainable economic growth and employment and a rising standard of living in Member countries, while maintaining financial stability, and thus to contribute to the development of the world economy;*
- *to contribute to sound economic expansion in Member as well as non-member countries in the process of economic development*
- *to contribute to the expansion of world trade on a multilateral, non-discriminatory basis in accordance with international obligations.*

The legal personality possessed by the Organisation for European Economic Co-operation continues in the OECD, which came into being on 30th September 1961.

The members of OECD are: Austria, Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, the Federal Republic of Germany, Greece, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Norway, Portugal, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Turkey, the United Kingdom and the United States.

The Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia is associated in certain work of the OECD, particularly that of the Economic and Development Review Committee.

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by the Economic and Development Review Committee
in June 1968.

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INTRODUCTION

The expansion of activity accelerated in 1967, unlike the situation in many other countries. The acceleration was partly due to a sharp increase in exports of shipping services, while the rise in exports of goods (excluding ships) slowed down somewhat. Moreover, domestic demand increased faster than earlier, with some weakening of the types of demand most sensitive to cyclical influences more than offset by a stronger advance of other types of demand partly due to a more stimulative government policy. Prices continued their upward movement and the rise in labour costs accelerated. The current externel deficit increased, reflecting notably higher imports of ships and the growing trade deficit, but the deterioration was moderated by a marked increase in shipping earnings. In 1968 the expansion of activity is likely to continue but at a somewhat lower rate than earlier because of a shortening of the working week. With most wage and income settlements being re-negotiated this year, labour costs may show a further significant increase. The current external deficit should decline, mainly because of higher freight earnings and lower imports of ships.

I RECENT TRENDS

Output and Demand

1967

Real GNP rose by 5.3 per cent from 1966 to 1967, much faster than the expansion of output in the OECD area as a whole (3.4 per cent) or in OECD Europe (2.7 per cent). 1967 was the fifth consecutive year with strong economic growth; on average during the last five years output has increased by 5.1 per cent a year. The expansion last year was marked by exceptionally strong advance in a few sectors, particularly mining, building and construction, fishing and shipping. More than 2 percentage points of the total production increase can be ascribed to these sectors. Agricultural output fell, continuing the downward trend of recent years. The rise in production in manufacturing, usually stronger than in the rest of the economy, weakened.

In most post-war years there has been a shortage of labour. In 1967, also, the labour market was characterised by low unemployment with shortages of skilled workers, especially in the service industries. Registered unemployment, on average 0.7 per cent of the total labour force, was somewhat lower than in the year before, but on a seasonally adjusted basis the tendency during the year was slightly upwards. The strain on the labour market was eased to a greater extent than in recent years by a relatively big supply of new entrants to the labour force. The number of wage and salary earners increased by 1.9 per cent; the increase in total employment was smaller (1.1 per cent) because of a decline in the number of self-employed. In the two preceding years, total employment had risen by 0.7 per cent per year. The strong rise in employment in 1967 was probably due to a relatively high entrance of young people to the labour force and to greater labour force participation of married women. Employment increased most strongly in the building and construction sector (4 per cent) and in the service sectors (2.1 per cent); the rise in manufacturing was smaller (1 per cent). Agriculture, forestry and fishing continued to release labour corresponding to about 0.5 per cent of the total labour force.

Table 1 shows that exports of goods and services as well as domestic demand increased faster than in the previous year, apparently unaffected by the weakening of demand in several other countries. It can be seen, however, that the acceleration of the growth of exports was to a large extent due to a bunching of exports of ships[1]. Moreover, as already noted, exports of shipping services increased markedly, influenced by the continued rapid growth of the merchant fleet and stronger foreign demand for shipping services associated with the closure of the Suez Canal. The rise in exports of goods (excluding ships) slowed down somewhat, reflecting a weaker trend in demand abroad, notably in Germany.

With regard to domestic demand, Table 1 shows that the acceleration last year was due to stronger advances in public consumption and gross fixed asset formation, while private consumption rose at about the same rate as in the previous year, and inventory accumulation was replaced by some decumulation. However, the usual breakdown of demand as given in Table 1 is not the best indicator of cyclical changes in demand and their impact on activity—first because it does not distinguish between private and public fixed investment expenditure and, second, because the movement of domestic demand includes significant

1 Covering both second-hand ships sold by Norwegian shipowners and deliveries of new ships to foreigners from Norwegian shipyards.

Table 1 **Supply and Use of Resources**
Percentage change from previous year

	1964	1965	1966	1967
Private consumption	3.5	3.2	4.3	4.2
Public consumption	5.8	8.8	3.0	4.7
Gross fixed asset formation	3.5	6.9	5.6	12.0
of which: Ships	3.2	16.7	1.0	20.8
Change in stocks[1]	0.2	1.5	1.5	–0.1
DOMESTIC DEMAND	4.6	6.2	4.4	5.7
Exports	10.7	6.8	7.5	10.8
Goods (excl. ships)	..	5.5	8.8	6.7
Ships	..	29.4	–14.0	74.4
Gross freight earnings	..	8.6	5.8	10.3
Other services	..	0.1	17.7	12.1
Imports	8.0	9.4	8.7	11.7
Goods (excl. ships	..	8.4	11.6	8.3
Ships	..	20.4	–8.2	45.9
Shipping expenses abroad	..	7.8	7.8	2.4
Other services	..	1.7	19.9	7.2
GROSS DOMESTIC PRODUCT	5.5	5.3	4.0	5.3

1 Per cent of GDP.
Source: Revised National Budget, 1968.

fluctuations in investment in ships which have little to do with current investment demand, and which in any case have little impact on domestic activity because they mainly affect imports.

Table 2 provides a different breakdown. It excludes investment in ships, and distinguishes between two groups of demand. The first includes commodity exports, private non-residential fixed investment, and inventory accumulation, the types of demand most sensitive to short-term cyclical influences and over which the authorities have little direct control (in the following referred to as autonomous demand components). The second includes central and local government expenditure on goods and services and residential construction which in Norway are to a large extent determined by government policy (policy-determined demand components). The table also distinguishes the direct contribution to GNP of the shipping sector since this is heavily influenced by the increase in the fleet due to contracts made several years earlier and the size of laid-up tonnage (which did not change much last year). In estimating the impact on domestic activity of changes in the types of demand referred to above, secondary (" multiplier ") effects on private incomes and consumption have in principle been included[1].

1 The size of the multipliers—estimated on the basis of input-output statistics—varies between 0.8 and 1.4 depending on the type of demand.

Table 2 **Analysis of the Growth of GDP**
Changes in volume (1961 prices) from previous year
in per cent of GDP, including estimated multiplier effects

	1965	1966	1967
Autonomous demand components	3.2	3.0	1.5
Export of goods excl. ships	1.8	1.7	1.3
Private investments excl. ships and dwellings	0.5	1.3	1.1
Inventory accumulation	0.9	0	–0.9
Policy-determined components	1.3	1.0	1.9
Central government expenditure on goods and services	0.9	0.2	1.0
Local government expenditure on goods and services	0.2	0.5	0.3
Investments in dwellings	0.2	0.3	0.6
Direct contribution from the shipping sector	1.1	0.7	1.3
Residual	–0.4	–0.7	0.6
Actual change in GDP	5.2	4.0	5.3

Source: Secretariat estimates.

It can be seen that the autonomous demand components, taken together, continued to grow in 1967, but their expansionary impact was much smaller than earlier, falling from 3 per cent of GNP in 1966 to 1.5 per cent in 1967. The expansionary impulse provided by commodity exports and private non-residential fixed investment, although smaller than earlier, remained significant, but the shift from inventory accumulation to decumulation represented an important deflationary influence. The slowdown of the growth of the autonomous demand components was partly offset by a faster increase in policy-determined demand components. Purchases of goods and services by local authorities rose rather less than in the previous year, but central government expenditure on goods and services and residential construction increased much faster than earlier. The marked increase in the shipping sector also contributed to the acceleration of the growth of GNP.

Seasonally adjusted data suggest that the expansion of industrial production slowed down somewhat in the first half of 1967, notably reflecting some weakening of the upward trend in commodity exports. With renewed increase in exports in the second half of the year, industrial production also resumed its growth.

The First Months of 1968

In the first half of 1968 the expansion of commodity exports (excluding ships) has continued. The growth in industrial production has, however, slowed down, mainly due to reduced investment demand. Unemployment (seasonally adjusted) rose somewhat to about 1 per cent of the labour force. These developments were to some extent influenced by temporary factors operating on the supply side, notably an exceptionally low herring catch which had adverse effects on activity in the fish-processing industry and on exports. Activity was, however, still on a high level, with the labour market remaining relatively tight.

Incomes and Prices

Table 3 shows that total factor income in 1967 rose rather more than in the year before, reflecting a stronger advance in output and some improvement in the external terms of trade for goods and services. More than one-fourth of the rise in total factor income was used for increased social premiums paid by the entrepreneurs, largely owing to the introduction of a general pension scheme at the beginning of the year. The total wage bill (including social premiums, fringe benefits, etc.) rose by 12.5 per cent, considerably more than in recent years, and the wage share of total factor income increased from 65.4 per cent in 1966 to 67.3 per cent in 1967 (Table 4); in the years 1960-65 the wage share had averaged 64.1 per cent. Excluding social premiums paid by the entrepreneurs, however, the wage share has remained fairly stable in recent years.

Table 3 **Development of Factor Incomes**
Percentage change from previous year

	1964	1965	1966	1967
Private factor incomes	10.6	11.1	7.2	8.7
Wages and salaries[1]	8.7	9.9	10.5	12.5
Agriculture, forestry, fishing	24.3	20.6	4.3	–6.4
Other private income	14.9	11.8	0.5	3.2
Public income from capital and income paid to abroad	–17.3	–3.8	–2.5	69.1
NET NATIONAL INCOME	10.1	10.9	7.1	9.2

1 Including fringe benefits.
Source: Economic Survey, 1967.

Table 4 **Distribution of Factor Incomes**
Per cent

	1964	1965	1966	1967
Wages and salaries	64.0	63.4	65.4	67.3
of which:				
Employers' contributions to social security	3.4	3.6	4.2	6.2
Other factor incomes	36.0	36.6	34.6	32.7
Sheltered industries	25.0	24.6	23.7	23.3
Exposed industries[1]	11.0	12.0	10.9	9.4
NET FACTOR INCOME	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0

1 Exposed industries are those which by the authorities are considered as exposed to foreign competition i.e. forestry, fishing, whaling, mining, maritime transport, air transport and manufacturing industries working on export markets or under competition from imported goods.

Source: Norwegian National Accounts.

Total non-wage income rose only slightly from 1966 to 1967. Although the terms of trade improved somewhat, average export and import prices did not change much, and as the increase in weages was larger than the increase in productivity, non-wage income fell in industries exposed to foreign competition. In the " sheltered " industries (see Table 4), non-wage income rose somewhat, but not sufficiently to maintain its share of total factor income. This is a remarkable development, as the non-wage share of factor income in these industries has been relatively stable in recent years, with rising costs being offset by higher prices. It is possible that some industries classified as " sheltered " in reality are exposed to foreign competition, and that the latter exerted a stabilising influence on prices last year.

Table 5 **Hourly Wage Costs in Manufacturing**
Percentage change from previous year

	1964	1965	1966	1967	Average 1964-67
Total hourly wage costs	9.4	10.3	8.2	10.0	9.5
of which due to:					
Negotiated increases	2.7	4.5	3.2	3.1	3.4
Wage-drift	3.1	3.4	2.9	3.3	3.2
Fringe benefits, etc.	3.6	2.4	2.1	3.6	2.9

Source: Report from Expert Committee on Income Settlements, 1968.

There were only few wage negotiations in 1967, but most wage and salary earners received pay increases provided for by the settlements concluded in 1966, partly in the form of cost-of-living adjustments. As a result, the increase in negotiated earnings (about 3 per cent) was of about the same magnitude as in the previous year. Including the effects of wage-drift and increased fringe benefits, average hourly wage costs in manufacturing rose by 10 per cent from 1966 to 1967. Table 5 shows that both in 1967 and in earlier years roughly one-third of the rise in hourly wage costs resulted from negotiated increases, one-third from wage-drift and one-third from social expenses.

Table 6 **Unit Labour Cost in Manufacturing**
Percentage change from previous year

	United States	Canada	Industrialised OECD Europe[1]	Norway
1962	–1.7	–0.4	4.8	6.5
1963	–0.8	–0.2	2.7	0.9
1964	0.0	–0.5	2.1	1.5
1965	–1.3	5.3	4.7	3.4
1966	3.0	0.0	4.1	5.4
1967[2]	5.2	4.3	1.2	7.7
Average 1962-1967	1.2	1.4	3.3	4.2

1 Weighted together according to their estimated importance for Norwegian foreign trade.
2 Preliminary estimates.

Source: OECD Secretariat.

NOTE Unit labour cost is in principle defined as the total of employers' outlay to wages and salaries (including indirect payments) per unit of output calculated on the basis of national accounts data.

Table 6 suggests that the cost position of Norwegian manufacturing industry relative to that of competing countries may have remained roughly unchanged during the years 1962 to 1965. But it seems to have deteriorated significantly in 1966 and 1967. In these two years, the rise in unit labour costs accelerated in Norway while it slowed down in several competing countries. Moreover, in the last couple of years, productivity in manufacturing has increased rather less than in competing countries. The devaluation of pound sterling and certain other currencies towards the end of 1967 (not taken into account in Table 6) also aggravated the relative cost position of Norwegian industry.

Most collective wage and income agreements expire in 1968. The income settlements of the farmers and fishermen have been re-negotiated with the Government. In the wage negotiations conducted during the first months of the year between the central labour and employers organisations, agreement was reached on an average pay increased of 4.4 per cent in industry and handicraft in 1968 as compensation for the reduction in the working week from 45 to 42.5 hours from July, increases for special trades and low wage groups amounting to 1.8 per cent of the total wage bill in the industries concerned, and a general increase of 2 per cent from 1st January 1969. The agreement is valid for two years, and includes a price-escalator clause; wages will be adjusted if the new consumer price index to be introduced next year shows a change of 5 per cent or more compared with the January 1969 level. It is very unlikely that this clause will come into effect. Social premiums paid by entrepreneurs should increase less than in 1967, when they rose markedly because of the introduction of the new pension scheme, but the effect of wage-drift may be of about the same magnitude as last year. Hourly earnings in manufacturing seem likely to rise by some 9-10 per cent in the course of the year.

In order to provide those responsible for the income negotiations a better basis for judging the effects of the income settlements, the Government, in good time before the income negotiations started, called upon a group of experts, partly representatives from the organisations mainly concerned, to analyse the economic effects of alternative wage increases and price compensations. On the basis of an econometric model, the expert group estimated the repercussions in 1968 and 1969 of alternat-

Table 7 **Development of Consumer Prices**
January to January
Percentage changes, annual rates

	Average 1961-1966	Jan. 1966 to Jan. 1967	Jan. 1967 to Jan. 1968
Total change in consumer prices	4.2	4.2	4.1
of which due to:			
Domestic agricultural products	1.2	1.2	1.7
Other domestic products	1.8	1.7	1.0
Imported goods	0.2	0.1	0.4
Rent	0.2	0.2	0.2
Other services	0.8	1.0	0.8

Source: Report from Expert Committee on Income Settlements, 1968.

ive increases in wages and agricultural prices on consumer prices and real incomes. distinguishing between wages, farmers' and fishermen's incomes, profits in non-farm industries exposed to foreign competition and profits in non-farm industries not exposed to foreign competition.

During 1967 consumer prices rose by 4.3 per cent, i.e. at about the same rate as in the year before, and in line with the average annual increase experienced so far in the 1960's. Table 7 shows that the price rise in recent years has been caused almost entirely by domestic factors, as prices on imported goods have increased very moderately. In the first quarter of 1968 consumer prices rose by some 4 per cent at annual rate.

Balance of Payments

The current deficit rose in 1967. The deficit on merchandise trade (excluding ships) increased sharply, with imports rising in sympathy with the strong expansion of activity and the growth of exports slowing down; the deterioration was only partly offset by the strong rise in exports of new ships from Norwegian shipyards. Moreover, the contribution of the shipping sector fell somewhat last year, the rise in net freight earnings being more than offset by the strong increase in net imports of ships. Net tourist receipts also fell somewhat, while the surplus on " other services " showed a marked increase.

Table 8 **Balance of Payments**
$ million

	1964	1965	1966	1967
Trade balance, excl. ships	–513	–546	–631	–711
Export of new ships	20	48	29	74
Shipping sector[1], net	386	363	419	413
Tourism, net	10	12	17	12
Other services, net	80	84	77	109
Transfers, net	–57	–63	–73	–85
CURRENT ACCOUNT	–74	–102	–162	–188
Long-term capital	156	201	125	346
Short-term capital	–21	58	44	16
Errors and omissions	–23	25	23	42
NON-MONETARY TRANSACTIONS	38	182	30	216
Change in: Official exchange reserves	39	89	52	150
Other exchange reserves	–1	93	–22	66

1 Net freight earnings, exports of second-hand ships and imports of ships.
Source: Revised National Budget 1968 and Norwegian submission to the OECD.

Table 9 **Balance of Payments of the Shipping Sector**
$ million

	1964	1965	1966	1967
Net freight earnings	596	647	667	795
Export of secondhand ships	69	79	89	139
Import of ships	–278	–363	–336	–521
Net interest payments	–45	–49	–57	–64
CURRENT ACCOUNT	342	314	363	349
Borrowing related to ship imports	48	100	66	227
Lending related to ship exports[1]	–6	–11	2	–9
OVERALL BALANCE	384	403	431	567

1 Second hand ships only.
Source: Revised National Budget 1968.

The current account deficit fell sharply in the second half of the year, when a small surplus ($ 13 million) replaced the large deficit of the first half ($ 200 million). The improvement was mainly the result of higher net freight earnings, reflecting the rise in freight rates associated with the closure of the Suez Canal and the strong growth of the merchant fleet; moreover, net imports of ships fell, and the resumption of faster growth of commodity exports also contributed. The first quarter of 1968 also showed a surplus on current account, mainly because freight earnings remained high and imports of ships low.

Norway increased its share of foreign markets in 1967, continuing the relatively good performance of recent years. The improvement last year, however, may have been due mainly to the bunching of exports of ships. EFTA accounted for most of the improvement; the share of the EEC market changed little and Norway lost ground in the US market. About 80 per cent of the increase in commodity exports went to EFTA countries, to some extent reflecting the removal of the UK import surcharge in November 1966, and the abolition of tariffs on manufactured products within EFTA from the beginning of 1967. This area now takes almost half of Norwegian commodity exports. About half the increase in commodity exports (excluding ships) in 1967 could be ascribed to exports of engineering products, a continuation of the strong upward trend in exports of highly processed goods experienced in recent years. Moreover, there was a good rise in shipments of chemicals and herring meal. On the other hand, marketing conditions weakened for several important exports such as fertilizers, fish and fish products, animal fats, pulp and fur skins. Commodity exports (season-

Table 10 **Market Shares of Exports**
Manufactured products and crude materials
Imports from Norway in per cent of total imports[1]

	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967[2]
EFTA (including Finland)	2.53	2.47	2.36	2.41	2.52	2.59	2.77	2.85
EEC	0.93	0.87	0.88	0.94	0.96	0.90	0.90	9.02
United States	0.78	0.81	0.66	0.78	0.82	0.71	0.57	0.52
Total	1.42	1.38	1.31	1.38	1.44	1.41	1.44	1.46

1 Shares of individual countries weighed together with imports in 1960.
2 Preliminary estimates.
Source: U.N. statistical papers series D and OECD Foreign Trade Statistics, series B.

ally adjusted) were rather flat in the first three quarters; there was a sharp increase in the last quarter, and a continued growth in the first months of 1968.

Imports of goods (excluding ships) rose by 7.4 per cent in value and 8 per cent in volume in 1967, with investment goods showing the strongest increase (13 per cent). On a seasonally adjusted basis, imports levelled off in the second half of the year, with a decline in the fourth quarter, but recovered again in 1968.

The inflow of long-term capital increased sharply last year, as the shipping companies and other business sectors increased their long-term borrowing strongly; the public sector, however, continued to reduce its foreign debt. The official gold and foreign exchange holdings (including the IMF position) rose by $ 150 million, and the banks also increased their foreign assets. The official reserves remained unchanged in the first four months of 1968 and amounted to $ 680 million at the end of April.

II ECONOMIC POLICY

In 1967 high priority was given to the development of public investment and services in several fields, resulting in a more expansionary budget than earlier. With the smaller scope for expansion in 1968 because of the shortening of the working week, and given the expectation of stronger foreign demand, the 1968 budget is designed to restrict the

growth of domestic demand. Although monetary policy was gradually tightened during 1967, the supply of credit was somewhat higher than intended.

Fiscal Policy

The budget for 1967 was rather more expansive than its predecessor. The increase in appropriations was especially high for communications, education and research, and social purposes. Despite some restrictive measures taken in the spring, including postponement of public spending and lending, expenditure on goods and services measured in constant prices rose by about 8 per cent compared to about 4 per cent in the preceding year. Some reductions were made in direct taxation to modify the progressivity of tax rates, and the sales tax on books and weekly magazines was abolished. Together, these changes reduced revenue by Kr. 135 million on a annual basis. Other tax reductions —inter alia to stimulate personal and company savings—were also approved in 1967, but had only small effects on revenue in that year; in a full year revenue is estimated to be reduced by Kr. 150 million. The financial surplus was somewhat lower in 1967 than in the year before.

Table 11 **Central Government Budget**
Kr. million

	1965	1966	1967		1968
	Actual	Actual	Actual	Approved Budget[2]	Approved Budget[2]
CURRENT REVENUE	10 225	11 322	12 636	12 286	13 570
CURRENT AND INVESTMENT EXPENDITURE	10 023	10 829	12 185	12 267	13 378
Consumption	4 017	4 368	4 953	5 151	5 643
Fixed investment	1 679	1 864	2 105	2 031	2 143
Transfers	4 327	4 597	5 127	5 085	5 601
FINANCIAL SAVINGS	202	493	451	19	192
LENDINGS, NET (— = increase)	–1 559	–1 347	–1 591	–1 724	–2 064
FLOATING DEBT	—	52	62	64	25
OVERALL BALANCE[1]	–1 357	–802	–1 078	–1 641	–1 847

1 Before public borrowing.
2 With net supplementary appropriation approved or proposed up to March.
Source: Revised National Budget 1968 and previous years.

The budget for 1968 is designed to be less expansive than the 1967 budget. Measured in constant prices, expenditure on goods and services should increase by some 3 per cent against 8 per cent in 1967. The rise in transfer expenditures should also slow down somewhat. From 1st January 1968 the general sales tax was extended to cover dwellings. As a system of compensating transfers from the Government was introduced for dwellings up to a certain size, the system will discourage the building of big and expensive houses and apartments; the net revenue increase in 1968 is estimated at Kr. 200 million. In order to prevent an increase in tax incidence as nominal incomes rise, a further reduction has been made in direct taxation to modify the progressivity of tax rates. This is estimated to cost Kr. 125 million in less revenue. With a somewhat slower rise in the tax base, it is likely that the financial surplus will be of about the same magnitude as in 1967.

Monetary Policy

Total credit supply from domestic sources showed hardly any increase from 1966 to 1967, while an increase of about Kr. 300 million was envisaged in the National Budget. (The target of Kr. 5 000 million for 1967 which was based on erroneous assumptions about the outcome for 1966 was nevertheless exceeded.) Private borrowing abroad exceeded the ceiling fixed by the authorities, partly because the inflow of short—and medium-terme trade credits—which are liberalised—was larger than foreseen. Total credit expansion therefore contributed more than originally envisaged to the growth of demand.

Last year, in order to regulate lending from commercial and savings banks, the authorities relied heavily on minimum reserve requirements. Moreover, according to an agreement concluded in the spring between the authorities and the commercial banks, these banks should seek to keep the increase in their advances within a ceiling of Kr. 700 million and, as far as their liquidity position permitted, invest in long-term bonds. Nevertheless, in the summer and autumn (allowing for seasonal variations) lending from both commercial and savings banks exceeded the ceilings. In September the Monetary and Credit Act was changed so as to require the banks to observe minimum reserve ratios on a continuing basis, and not only on the last day of the month. Compared with the earlier practice this represented a considerable tightening of existing reserve requirements, especially for the commercial banks. In November the reserve requirement ratios were increased by 1 percentage point both for commercial and savings banks. These measures had a dampening effect on bank lending, but at the end of 1967 bank lending

Table 12 **The Credit Market**
Net increase in outstanding loans. Kr. million

	1966		1967		1968
	Targets	Actual	Targets	Actual	Targets
Commercial banks	600	934	700	823	950
Savings banks	500	695	550	769	800
Life insurance companies	350	391	300	314	300
State banks	950	765	1 200	1 080	1 400
Loan associations, etc.	400	374	400	302	500
Bond issues, net	100	221	260	217	300
Other sources[1]	1 500	2 197	1 590	2 086	1 750-2 050
Total domestic credit supply	4 400	5 577	5 000	5 591	6 000-6 300
Net direct borrowing abroad	1 300	1 206	2 100	2 553	1 000
of which: shipping companies	400	419	1 500	1 506	—
Total credit supply	5 700	6 783	7 100	8 144	7 000-7 300

1 The share market, public funds, etc.
Sources: Norwegian submission to the OECD, Revised National Budget 1968.

was still well above the suggested ceiling. The excessive increase in lending from private banks was partly offset by the fact that lending from the state banks, notably the housing bank, fell short of the volume envisaged by the authorities; net borrowing from the credit associations also was less than envisaged. But the supply of credit from other sources increased much more than planned.

As in the previous year, the market for state and state-guaranteed bonds was easy in 1967, partly because these bonds are included in the banks' minimum liquidity reserves according to the Monetary and Credit Act. But the market for fixed interest securities other than government and government guaranteed bonds was strained. Both commercial and savings banks reduced their holdings of such securities in 1967, contrary to the authorities' assumptions. Nevertheless, the target for the gross volume of funds raised in the capital market by private and municipal borrowers was reached, inter alia because of participation from the Central Bank and the postal bank institutions.

Contrary to the expectations at the beginning of the year, the Central Government's financial transactions resulted in a much larger withdrawal of primary liquidity[1] in 1967 than in the two preceding

1 Defined as notes and coins, Treasury Bills, and deposits with the Central Bank and the Postal Current Account.

years. This was mainly due to exceptionally large domestic government short-term borrowing from the National Insurance Scheme which was established from 1st January 1967. This scheme is accumulating large funds, and will be an important source of credit in the future. The cash surplus in 1967 was about Kr. 800 million. The surplus will be invested in public and private bonds or, up to a certain limit, deposited with the banks, but as a board for the insurance scheme had not yet been appointed in 1967, most of the cash surplus was advanced as short term loans to the Government. Table 13 shows that the total central government transactions resulted in a withdrawal of primary liquidity of almost Kr. 1 billion. This was, however, more than offset by sales of foreign exchange to the Central Bank and also some other forms of liquidity supply by the bank.

The banks' liquidity position did not change much last year. With a good increase in deposits and the inflow of foreign funds, primary and secondary reserves in relation to total assets fell only slightly during the year. But bank reserves came under pressure in certain months, especially in December, when bank borrowing in the Central Bank was exceptionally large.

Table 13 **Developments in primary liquidity**[1]
Kr. million

	1965	1966	1967
1 Liquidity supply from Treasury and government funds before borrowing	726	601	1 011
2 Government domestic borrowing	–756	–849	–1 975
(*a*) Long-term loans	–676	–899	–1 091
(*b*) Short-term loans	–80	50	–884
3 Withdrawal of liquidity by the Treasury (1 + 2)	–30	–248	–964
4 Liquidity supply from banks, municipal and private sector through sales of foreign currency to the Bank of Norway	718	640	1 184
5 Liquidity supply through other Central Bank transactions	–165	38	119
Total liquidity supply (3 + 4 + 5)	523	430	339
Resulting in:			
Increased bank liquidity	149	66	–81
Increased liquidity in the private sector	374	364	420

1 Primary liquidity includes notes and coins, Treasury bills and deposits with the Central Bank and the Postal Current Account.

Source: Revised National Budget 1968.

In 1968 the authorities are aiming at a total credit supply of about Kr. 7 billion (Table 12). This is rather less than last year, because the shipping sector's borrowing abroad is likely to be negligible; other private borrowing abroad is expected to be of the same magnitude as last year, and the supply of credit from domestic sources should be considerably bigger than in 1967. Most credit institutions should share in the expansion, with the strongest increase in lending from the state banks, notably the Housing Bank, reflecting the authorities' policies to stimulate housebuilding. Lending from the private banks will be regulated by means of minimum reserve requirements, while direct lending from the life insurance companies is influenced by an agreement with the authorities concerning their investments in domestic bonds.

Despite the higher target adopted for the domestic credit expansion, the increase in total lending from private banks in the first five months of 1968 was significantly smaller than a year earlier. Several factors may have contributed to this, including reduced activity in forestry and the failure of the herring fishery in the winter. Moreover, the weaker trend in business fixed investment has probably reduced demand for credit, but bank liquidity has also been tighter. For the second quarter of the year the Central Bank therefore eased the conditions for its lending to the banks.

III PROSPECTS AND POLICY ISSUES

Prospects

With the working week being cut in July by more than 5 per cent for a large part of the labour force, the physical scope for expansion will be smaller than earlier. The authorities, assuming that two-fifths of the effect on capacity of the cut in working hours will be offset by higher productivity, estimate the growth of capacity at close to 4 per cent in both 1968 and 1969, one percentage point less per year than usual.

According to the revised national budget published in April, the authorities expect foreign demand to constitute an important expansionary element this year. Commodity exports (excluding ships) are thought likely to increase by 7.5 per cent in value, somewhat faster than last year. In the period January-May, commodity exports were 8.7 per cent above the year-ago level. A further increase during the remainder of

Table 14 **Prospects for Demand in 1968**
Percentage change from previous year, 1967 prices

	1967	1968[1]
Private consumption	4.2	3.5
Public consumption	4.7	4.5
Gross fixed asset formation	12.0	–0.5
Building and construction	7.8	3.5
Machines and transport equipment	10.5	2.5
Ships and boats	20.8	–11
Change in stocks[2]	–0.1	–0.4
Domestic expenditure	5.7	2
Exports of goods and services	10.8	5.5-6
Goods (excluding ships)	6.7	7.5
Ships	74.4	–20
Gross freight earnings	10.3	9
Other exports	12.1	1
Total demand	7.3	3
Imports	11.7	0
Goods (excluding ships)	8.3	4.5-5
Ships	45.9	–32
Shipping current expenditure	2.4	4.5
Other imports	7.2	12-12.5
Gross National Product	7.2	4

1 Official estimates.
2 Per cent of GNP.
Source: Revised National Budget 1968.

the year—at an annual rate of perhaps 6 per cent between the first and fourth quarters—will be required if the export estimate is to be realised. An increase of this size is quite realistic, although it may have to be realised in the face of a marked slowdown in the growth of total OECD imports after the first quarter; Secretariat estimates suggest that the rise in OECD imports may slowdown to an annual rate of only 3 ½ per cent between the first and the second halves of this year. Moreover, the devaluation of pound sterling and certain other currencies will render more difficult a further strong expansion of Norway's exports.

Domestic demand should rise less fast than last year. Business fixed investment demand (excluding ships) weakened in the course of 1967; recent surveys of investment plans in manufacturing point to only a moderate rise in business fixed asset formation in 1968. The authorities expect a smaller increase in public investment than earlier. Invest-

ment in ships will fall, but the decline may only affect imports; the authorities expect deliveries to Norwegian shipowners from domestic shipyards to increase. Residential construction is the only major type of investment which is assumed to increase relatively fast, by 11 per cent, or at about the same rate as last year. Inventories may be reduced, partly because of lower production of herring oil and meal and other fish products due mainly to a sharp decline in herring catches during the first months of the year. But as inventories were reduced in 1967 also, the change in inventory investment should represent less of a deflationary factor than last year. The authorities expect public consumption to increase at about the same rate as in 1967. Although hourly wage rates are likely to continue to rise fast, given the increases provided for by the recent wage settlements, the reduction of the working week will limit the growth of the wage bill, and consumer prices may well rise almost at the same rate as last year (about 4 per cent). The growth of private consumption in real terms may therefore slow down.

On this basis, the authorities expect an increase in real GNP of about 4 per cent, about in line with the estimated increase in productive potential, suggesting that the labour market will remain tight. On the assumptions adopted, it is possible that the strain on the labour market will increase in the second half of the year, following the slight rise in unemployment in the first half. As already noted, the export estimate implies a continued rise throughout the year, and it is not evident that the assumptions concerning domestic demand entail a slower advance in the second half. It is possible that final domestic demand (excluding stocks) will be relatively steady, while the estimate for inventory demand seems to imply some strengthening in the course of the year as the expected decumulation to a large extent seems to have taken place in the first quarter. However, if the export forecast proves to be too optimistic, the weakening of the rise in exports which then seems likely may also influence the business climate at home. On this basis, the advance in aggregate demand could be more moderate, and more in line with the growth of productive capacity.

The authorities expect a considerable decline in the current external deficit in 1968, mainly reflecting a marked fall in imports of ships following the big increase last year. The deficit on the trade balance (excluding ships) is assumed to remain at the 1967 level, despite the expected acceleration of the growth of exports. Although the rise in imports is thought likely to slow down from 7.4 per cent in 1967 to 5 per cent in 1968, it will about offset the increase in exports. The trade balance would, of course, deteriorate if exports rose less than assumed.

The development of freight rates is uncertain; but even on the assumption of some decline from now on, the authorities envisage an increase in net shipping earnings. Net receipts on other services are expected to decline somewhat. The current deficit is likely to be financed by borrowing abroad by private and public enterprises; net borrowing by the shipping sector, however, may be negligible this year.

Although it may be early to make a full forecast for 1969, it is possible to have a view on certain features in the situation. Business inventories fell in the course of 1967 and may show a further fall in 1968. The decline is likely to cease or be reversed in 1969. Business fixed investment demand is also expected to be relatively weak in 1968, partly because of the completion of certain big projects, and may recover in 1969. If, in addition, exports should show an increase in line with the average of recent years—about 10 per cent a year—the demand components most sensitive to cyclical influences should rise much faster than this year. This suggests that the general demand picture may be stronger than in 1968.

Conclusion

In 1967, with a marked slowdown of the growth of activity in the OECD area, strong expansion was maintained in Norway. The recessionary impulses were not very strong. and such weakening as there was in the types of demand most sensitive to cyclical influences (commodity exports and business investment) were offset by a more rapid increase in other demand components, notably public expenditure on goods and services and residential construction. But prices, and especially labour costs, rose rapidly and there was a further deterioration in the trade balance.

An important objective of economic policy must now be to moderate the rise in labour costs. With the increase which seems likely in 1968, unit labour costs in manufacturing will have risen by about 15 per cent over a three-year period, much faster than in most other industrialised countries. In addition, the relative cost position for certain industries has been adversely affected by the devaluation of the pound sterling and some other currencies. The wage settlement concluded in 1968 points to a slowdown of the rise in costs in 1969. Nevertheless, it is clearly important to avoid a strengthening of demand pressures; some easing might well be appropriate in order to hold down the rise in wages resulting from wage-drift.

An easing of the pressure on resources would also seem desirable from the point of view of the balance of payments. The trade deficit has risen sharply in recent years, and prospects for shipping earnings—the main offset to the trade deficit—are uncertain. Freight rates have been low in the last few years. They rose sharply in 1967 after the closure of the Suez Canal. In the long run, however, given the likelihood of a continued rapid expansion of the world shipping fleet in coming years, freight rates may tend to remain relatively low. It is therefore uncertain to what extent a continued rapid rise in shipping earnings can be counted on to cover a further increase in the trade deficit. Given the fact that there is still a shortage of labour, some easing of demand pressures should not have any major adverse impact on the employment situation. But it would help to arrest the growth of the trade deficit by limiting the rise in imports and providing room and incentives for a stronger increase in exports.

The immediate implications for economic policy of the desirability of lowering the pressure of demand are difficult to assess. Although the cut in the working week will reduce the growth of capacity this year, the extent to which it will do so is uncertain as part of the adverse effect of the productive potential may be offset by a stronger rise in output per man-hour. The movement of demand over the next few months is also uncertain, particularly the trend of exports. In view of these uncertainties, flexibility in policy-making in the months ahead is essential. However, as policy measures taken in the next few months will only affect demand with some delay, the probable course of demand in 1969 must be an important consideration behind the policy decisions to be taken during the remainder of the present year. As noted earlier, it seems likely that aggregate demand will rise faster in 1969 than in 1968. A cautious approach in demand-management policy would therefore seem to be required. In particular, it is important that the budget for 1969 should be formulated with a view to restricting the growth of demand.

STATISTICAL ANNEX

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Table A **Supply and Use of Resources**
Kr. million, current prices

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
Consumers' expenditure on goods and services	16 768	17 787	18 952	20 561	22 179	23 618	25 771	27 622	29 712	32 368
General government current expenditure on goods and services	3 990	4 363	4 588	5 014	5 807	6 391	7 124	8 215	9 071	10 040
Defence	967	1 031	1 024	1 104	1 285	1 375	1 483	1 815	1 842	2 062
Civil	3 023	3 332	3 564	3 910	4 522	5 016	5 641	6 400	7 229	7 978
Gross fixed asset formation	9 298	9 039	9 298	10 539	11 242	12 321	12 797	14 423	15 777	18 453
Change in stocks	–273	–217	405	552	108	3	196	732	893	–52
National Expenditure	29 783	30 972	33 243	36 666	39 336	42 333	45 888	50 992	55 453	60 809
Exports of goods and services (non-factor)	11 690	12 543	13 431	14 154	14 763	16 212	18 612	20 367	22 176	25 108
Imports of goods and services (non-factor)	12 459	12 814	13 998	15 188	15 657	17 014	18 571	20 450	22 584	25 600
Gross Domestic Product at Market Prices	28 924	30 701	32 676	35 632	38 442	41 531	45 929	50 909	55 045	60 317
Income payments from the rest of the world	181	203	242	236	246	236	261	348	444	501
Income payments to the rest of the world	447	487	578	629	700	797	890	1 046	1 224	1 359
Gross National Product at Market Prices	28 658	30 417	32 340	35 239	37 988	40 970	45 300	50 211	54 265	59 459
Indirect taxes	4 142	4 417	4 692	5 211	5 627	5 979	6 678	7 591	8 445	9 217
Subsidies	1 257	1 265	1 418	1 539	1 585	1 812	1 774	2 347	2 492	2 647
Gross National Product at Factor Cost	25 773	27 265	29 066	31 567	33 946	36 803	40 396	44 967	48 312	52 889
Depreciation and other operating provisions	3 847	4 178	4 386	4 674	4 942	5 232	5 591	6 318	6 922	7 669
Net National Product at Factor Cost	21 926	23 087	24 680	26 893	29 004	31 571	34 805	38 649	41 390	45 220

Source: Norwegian submission to the OECD.

Table B **Supply and Use of Resources**
Kr. million, 1958 prices

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
Consumers' expenditure on goods and services	16 768	17 428	18 495	19 611	20 250	21 005	21 775	22 395	23 359	24 337
General government current expenditure on goods and services	3 990	4 201	4 324	4 602	4 952	5 199	5 508	6 006	6 243	6 536
Defence	967	1 018	958	1 005	1 077	1 112	1 140	1 341	1 286	1 353
Civil	3 023	3 183	3 366	3 597	3 875	4 087	4 368	4 665	4 957	5 183
Gross fixed asset formation	9 298	8 874	8 960	9 973	10 448	11 351	11 707	12 452	13 114	14 938
Change in stocks	–273	–216	449	536	92	–51	165	687	707	124
National Expenditure	29 783	30 287	32 228	34 722	35 742	37 504	39 155	41 540	43 423	45 935
Exports of goods and services (non-factor)	11 690	12 805	13 971	15 009	15 957	17 640	19 511	20 848	22 468	24 915
Imports of goods and services (non-factor)	12 549	13 104	14 503	15 981	16 853	18 434	19 903	21 718	23 652	26 353
Gross Domestic Product at Market Prices	28 924	29 988	31 696	33 750	34 846	36 710	38 763	40 670	42 239	44 497
Income payment from the rest of the world	181	196	232	215	216	203	218	259	320	373
Income payments to the rest of the world	447	474	554	584	623	682	745	787	891	1 050
Gross National Product at Market Prices	28 658	29 710	31 374	33 381	34 439	36 231	38 236	40 142	41 668	43 820
Depreciation and other operating provisions	3 847	4 117	4 371	4 574	4 816	5 091	5 406	5 745	6 106	6 527
Net National Product at Market Prices	24 811	25 593	27 003	28 807	29 623	31 140	32 830	34 397	35 562	37 293

Source: Norwegian submission to the OECD.

Table C **Gross National Product by Industrial Origin**[1]

Kr. million, current prices

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
Agriculture	1 590	1 782	1 696	1 787	1 675	1 735	1 818	1 965	2 035	2 154
Forestry, hunting, etc.	907	792	806	887	876	817	913	1 017	876	867
Fishing and whaling	603	681	646	654	600	612	761	1 063	1 209	989
Mining and quarrying	305	279	300	302	333	349	395	452	544	575
Manufacturing	6 714	7 151	7 807	8 521	9 123	9 886	10 910	12 200	13 108	13 912
Electricity, gas and water works	717	767	866	912	1 056	1 063	1 184	1 282	1 389	1 554
Construction	1 907	2 016	2 095	2 299	2 645	2 955	3 037	3 377	3 881	4 514
Water transportation	3 129	3 157	3 292	3 513	3 702	4 052	4 566	5 039	5 282	6 135
Other transportation and communication	1 687	1 805	1 949	2 167	2 369	2 524	2 740	3 023	3 309	3 580
Wholesale and retail trade	3 108	3 239	3 664	4 013	4 350	4 963	5 336	5 834	6 080	6 890
Banking, insurance, real estate	633	706	763	881	897	952	1 077	1 169	1 211	1 341
Ownership of dwellings	865	922	995	1 073	1 151	1 232	1 303	1 427	1 509	1 621
Public administration and defence	1 195	1 294	1 362	1 426	1 603	1 760	1 953	2 157	2 342	2 620
Health and educational services	1 280	1 429	1 534	1 777	2 098	2 359	2 651	3 044	3 454	3 858
Miscellaneous services	1 399	1 529	1 627	1 748	1 922	2 105	2 381	2 616	2 863	3 137
GROSS DOMESTIC PRODUCT AT FACTOR COST	26 039	27 549	29 402	31 960	34 400	37 364	41 025	45 655	49 092	53 747
Net payments abroad	–266	–284	–336	–393	–454	–561	–629	–698	–780	–858
GROSS NATIONAL PRODUCT AT FACTOR COST	25 773	27 265	29 066	31 567	33 946	36 803	40 396	44 967	48 312	52 889

1 According to OECD definitions.

Source: Norwegian submission to the OECD.

Table D **Gross National Product by Industrial Origin**[1]
Kr. million, 1958 prices

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
Agriculture	1 590	1 623	1 591	1 660	1 506	1 585	1 514	1 481	1 428	1 361
Forestry, hunting, etc.	907	812	821	829	820	772	832	840	643	675
Fishing and whaling	603	648	595	568	541	495	580	743	839	918
Mining and quarrying	305	310	330	343	379	412	437	471	477	563
Manufacturing	6 714	7 009	7 643	8 061	8 404	8 923	9 648	10 172	10 773	11 071
Electricity, gas and water works	717	722	792	825	891	941	1 003	1 094	1 145	1 204
Construction	1 907	1 891	1 896	1 916	2 022	2 131	2 214	2 178	2 276	2 434
Water transportation	3 129	3 303	3 640	4 027	4 373	4 780	5 037	5 556	5 865	6 585
Other transportation and communication	1 687	1 782	1 875	2 024	2 106	2 157	2 333	2 389	2 530	2 642
Wholesale and retail trade	3 108	3 268	3 527	3 969	4 084	4 301	4 441	4 459	4 603	4 873
Banking, insurance, real estate	633	669	712	764	772	819	830	872	879	931
Ownership of dwellings	865	883	903	920	972	1 015	1 050	1 110	1 145	1 190
Public administration and defence	1 195	1 220	1 245	1 280	1 304	1 352	1 412	1 447	1 464	1 537
Health and education services	1 280	1 375	1 428	1 566	1 711	1 790	1 879	1 999	2 107	2 188
Miscellaneous services	1 399	1 471	1 527	1 608	1 648	1 675	1 760	1 800	1 843	1 876
GROSS DOMESTIC PRODUCT AT FACTOR COST	26 039	26 986	28 515	30 360	31 533	33 148	34 970	36 611	38 017	40 048
Net payments abroad	–266	–278	–322	–369	–407	–479	–527	–528	–571	–677
GROSS NATIONAL PRODUCT AT FACTOR COST	25 773	26 708	28 193	29 991	31 126	32 669	34 443	36 083	37 446	39 371

1 According to OECD definitions.
Source: Norwegian submission to the OECD.

Table E **Gross Fixed Asset Formation**[1]
Kr. million, 1958 prices

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
PRODUCT CLASSIFICATION										
Land	93	113	93	76	45	34	41	40	38	45
Dwellings	1 273	1 281	1 286	1 409	1 458	1 473	1 537	1 605	1 681	1 880
Other buildings	1 613	1 675	1 711	1 850	1 888	1 945	2 025	1 961	2 138	2 329
Other construction and works	1 115	1 129	1 210	1 196	1 489	1 659	1 716	1 773	1 785	1 875
Transport equipment	3 495	2 930	2 483	3 010	3 004	3 585	3 489	4 109	4 136	5 023
Other equipment	1 709	1 746	2 177	2 432	2 564	2 655	2 899	2 964	3 336	3 786
Total	9 298	8 874	8 960	9 973	10 448	11 351	11 707	12 452	13 114	14 938
BY INDUSTRY:										
Agriculture, forestry, fishing and whaling	834	845	849	741	749	751	777	809	883	880
Mining and quarrying	63	107	118	78	68	81	113	108	91	125
Manufacturing	1 207	1 090	1 400	1 673	1 763	1 690	1 726	1 787	2 125	2 406
Construction	136	168	201	216	220	191	260	308	345	372
Electricity, gas and waterworks	784	809	824	894	1 073	1 192	1 134	1 077	1 084	1 095
Transportation and communication	3 775	3 263	2 843	3 397	3 431	4 096	4 145	4 742	4 705	5 738
Dwellings	1 273	1 281	1 286	1 409	1 458	1 473	1 537	1 605	1 681	1 880
Public administration	27	26	22	27	60	69	69	61	61	69
Other service industries	1 199	1 285	1 417	1 538	1 626	1 808	1 946	1 955	2 139	2 373
INSTITUTIONAL CLASSIFICATION:										
Private enterprise	6 963	6 553	6 515	7 484	7 562	7 903	8 182	8 922	9 507	11 004
Public enterprise	1 321	1 216	1 306	1 358	1 598	1 944	1 843	1 882	1 886	2 045
General government	1 014	1 105	1 139	1 131	1 288	1 504	1 862	1 648	1 721	1 889

1 According to OECD definitions, which do not include maintenance and repair.
Source: Norwegian submission to the OECD.

Table F Main Economic Indicators

		1965				1966				1967				1968
		Q.1	Q.2	Q.3	Q.4	Q.1	Q.2	Q.3	Q.4	Q.1	Q.2	Q.3	Q.4	Q.1
NATIONAL PRODUCT (billion 1961 kroner):														
Gross domestic product	orig.	11.15	11.25	12.92	12.00	11.59	11.82	13.48	12.33	11.97	12.66	14.06	13.16	
	adj.	11.71	11.73	11.79	12.10	12.17	12.32	12.30	12.43	12.57	13.19	12.82	13.28	
Gross fixed investment	orig.	4.24	4.53	4.46	4.43	4.26	4.57	4.52	5.31	5.10	5.31	4.85	5.63	
	adj.	4.38	4.41	4.56	4.32	4.39	4.45	4.63	5.18	5.26	5.17	4.96	5.48	
INDUSTRIAL PRODUCTION (1963 = 100):														
Total	orig.	119	115	107	124	125	119	112	132	127	131	114	138	137
	adj.	113	115	116	117	118	120	122	124	127	125	125	130	131
Export goods	orig.	125	126	124	131	139	135	130	141	140	144	133	146	147
	adj.	123	126	129	130	128	131	133	137	135	134	135	143	145
Investment goods	orig.	116	108	98	122	126	113	105	132	128	128	105	135	136
	adj.	107	111	112	113	117	116	120	123	128	122	121	125	126
Consumer goods	orig.	107	105	97	115	112	109	99	120	113	117	101	123	118
	adj.	104	105	106	107	108	110	108	111	115	112	111	114	114
NEW ORDERS:														
Metal product industries (1963 = 100)		119	116	110	146	147	138	119	138	110	109	98	208	121
CONSTRUCTION:														
New housing started (thousands)		4.78	8.58	9.21	7.59	4.57	9.15	9.46	7.63	5.63	8.58	10.30	10.70	4.38
RETAIL SALES (1963 = 100)	orig.	94	117	118	136	102	123	130	147	111	135	139	157	120
	adj.	111	117	117	118	120	123	129	128	133	136	137	138	140
LABOUR (thousands):														
Employment in manufacturing (all employees)		348	354	357	355	355	360	363	362	361	365	368	364	361
Unemployment (registered unemployed)[1]	orig.	23.1	8.7	5.3	16.3	24.3	7.9	4.0	11.6	17.6	7.5	5.4	15.2	24.2
	adj.	13.6	12.8	12.9	13.1	14.3	11.5	9.5	9.3	10.7	11.9	13.1	12.6	14.6
Jobs vacant (unfilled vacancies)[1]	orig.	4.6	7.6	5.9	5.2	6.0	10.1	8.0	6.2	6.1	10.1	7.6	4.9	4.6
	adj.	5.4	5.5	5.8	6.9	7.0	7.5	7.8	8.1	7.3	7.4	7.4	6.3	5.5

1 Quarterly averages of end of month figures.

Source: OECD, Main Economic Indicators.

NOTE Orig.: Series prior to seasonal adjustment.
Adj. : Series adjusted for seasonal variations.

Table G **Wages and Prices**
1963 = 100

	1965				1966				1967				1968
	Q.1	Q.2	Q.3	Q.4	Q.1	Q.1	Q.3	Q.4	Q.1	Q.2	Q.3	Q.4	Q.1
Hourley earnings in industry[1]	111	117	117	119	118	123	127	128	128	133	135	138	
Consumer prices, total	110	110	111	111	113	113	115	116	117	119	120	121	121
Food	112	114	113	112	114	115	116	116	117	121	122	122	122
Non-food	107	108	109	110	112	112	114	115	116	118	119	120	121
Wholesale prices:													
Investment goods	102	103	103	103	104	105	105	105	106	107	107	107	108
Consumer goods	105	106	105	105	106	107	108	108	109	110	111	111	112
Raw materials	108	108	110	111	110	111	112	112	112	110	113	114	112
Building costs (dwellings in Oslo)[2]	109	110	110	111	113	116	116	116	117	119	119	120	

1 Males only; excluding holiday pay.
2 A/S Stormbull.

Source: OECD, Main Economic Indicators and Monthly Bulletin of Statistics, Central Bureau of Statistics.

Table H **Imports by Area (Countries of Origin)**
Kr. million

	1960	1961	1963	1963	1 964	1965	1966	1967
EFTA (incl. Finland)	4 007	4 684	4 803	5 746	5 817	6 640	7 235	8 662
Denmark	430	528	547	778	794	862	997	1 227
Sweden	1 663	1 885	2 041	2 492	2 740	3 348	3 227	3 813
Portugal	23	27	31	31	36	41	46	67
Switzerland	151	182	193	199	224	265	302	329
United Kingdom	1 571	1 811	1 781	2 083	1 876	1 902	2 350	2 784
Austria	68	86	98	88	97	105	120	163
Finland	101	165	112	75	86	117	193	279
EEC	3 434	3 721	3 703	3 879	4 091	4 599	4 777	4 930
Belgium-Luxembourg	308	313	326	302	357	380	384	411
France	337	351	447	474	481	689	532	589
Netherlands	595	603	573	662	715	715	758	763
Italy	163	179	249	235	304	318	346	491
Germany	2 031	2 275	2 108	2 206	2 234	2 497	2 757	2 676
Other European countries	496	497	511	560	774	693	745	828
African countries	272	276	370	267	383	375	365	415
Canada	510	533	492	487	510	588	671	579
United States	873	798	850	893	1 058	1 104	1 283	1 257
Mid and South America	540	595	772	638	568	752	784	831
Asia	285	392	323	461	864	955	1 239	1 984
Oceania + Miscellaneous	29	47	61	82	104	81	71	130
Total	10 446	11 543	11 885	13 013	14 169	15 787	17 170	19 617

Source: " External Trade ", Vol. III and Monthly Bulletin of External Trade, Central Bureau of Statistics.

Table 1 **Exports by Area (Countries of Destination)**
Kr. million

	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
EFTA (incl. Finland)	2 860	2 963	2 975	3 249	4 128	4 611	5 069	5 830
Denmark	400	525	606	540	629	741	791	978
Sweden	763	811	924	1 048	1 309	1 620	1 709	1 939
Portugal	31	21	31	39	34	46	34	68
Switzerland	70	71	62	72	92	116	121	129
United Kingdom	1 422	1 375	1 183	1 361	1 849	1 834	2 111	2 398
Austrai	49	50	47	50	61	59	66	61
Finland	125	110	122	139	154	195	237	257
EEC	1 616	1 648	1 872	2 063	2 417	2 584	2 711	2 887
Belgium-Luxembourg	134	121	121	127	144	200	213	257
France	162	215	248	270	371	321	335	340
Netherlands	238	223	206	244	310	353	314	346
Italy	218	191	247	254	240	294	352	402
Germany	864	898	1 050	1 168	1 352	1 416	1 497	1 542
Other European countries	428	436	467	617	708	798	940	891
African countries	307	274	287	334	364	509	494	588
Canada	26	32	42	41	49	68	88	82
United States	428	549	738	751	853	915	990	1 004
Mid and South America	306	314	241	297	282	327	385	419
Asia	237	368	252	244	329	408	406	611
Oceania and Miscellaneous	83	68	68	68	89	89	85	91
Total	6 291	6 652	6 942	7 664	9 219	10 309	11 168	12 403

Source: " External Trade ", Vol. III and Monthly Bulletin of External Trade, Central Bureau of Statistics.

Table J **Shipping Income and Expenditure Abroad**
Kr. million

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
Net freight earnings[1]	2 718	2 835	2 951	3 074	3 148	3 491	3 935	4 267	4 356	5 221
Net borrowing abroad	822	875	74	1 097	540	1 069	300	631	483	1 560
NET INCOME AND BORROWING ABROAD	3 540	3 710	3 025	4 171	3 688	4 560	4 235	4 898	4 839	6 781
Expenditure on imports of ships[2]	2 155	1 907	1 219	1 772	1 450	1 840	1 495	2 027	1 764	2 731
SURPLUS ON SHIPPING OPERATIONS ABROAD	1 385	1 803	1 806	2 399	2 238	2 720	2 740	2 871	3 075	4 050

1 Interest on mortgage loans abroad deducted.
2 Less exports of ships.
Source: Norwegian Ministry of Commerce.

Table K **Balance of Payments**
US $ million

	1958	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967
Exports, fob	752	816	886	941	982	1 084	1 298	1 453	1 577	1 748
Imports, fob	–1 264	–1 273	–1 395	–1 558	–1 603	–1 775	–1 924	–2 154	–2 349	–2 688
TRADE BALANCE	–512	–457	–509	–617	–621	–691	–626	–701	–772	–940
Freight and transportation	394	411	412	455	465	536	587	632	656	798
Travel	–7	–8	–3	–1	1	7	5	6	10	3
Investment income	–31	–33	–38	–40	–47	–58	–65	–70	–77	–86
Government transactions	9	18	19	12	19	17	32	10	20	27
Other services	–10	–9	–7	–8	–5	–2	–15	14	–3	9
BALANCE ON GOODS AND SERVICES	–157	–78	–126	–199	–188	–191	–82	–109	–166	–189
Net unilateral transfers	6	9	20	15	13	11	8	7	5	1
BALANCE ON CURRENT ACCOUNT	–151	–69	–106	–184	–175	–180	–74	–102	–161	–188
Net private long-term borrowing	119	154	41	117	83	185	92	166	142	369
Net private short-term borrowing	24	–46	49	–21	39	–11	–21	27	–7	–37
Net local governement borrowing	13	3	17	12	10	9	48	24	11	32
Net central borrowing	–3	–27	6	–6	–2	45	17	15	–20	–50
Erros and omissions	26	7	13	10	21	6	–22	26	24	38
OVERALL BALANCE	28	22	20	–72	–24	54	40	156	–11	161
Increase in commercial banks' net foreign assets	–10	–19	–8	–69	–21	3	–	68	–63	28
Increase in National Bank's net foreign assets	38	41	28	–3	–3	51	40	88	52	136

Source: Norwegian submission to the OECD.

Table L **Central Government Income and Expenditure**[1]
Fiscal years = Calendar years
Kr. million

	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967	1968[3]
Current revenue	8 115	8 513	9 446	10 616	11 485	12 661	14 496	16 243	18 695	19 780
Direct taxes	3 127	3 183	3 506	4 207	4 635	5 133	5 893	6 705	8 238	8 404
Indirect taxes	4 238	4 498	4 991	5 379	5 725	6 407	7 289	8 070	8 807	9 564
Other	750	832	949	1 030	1 125	1 121	1 314	1 468	1 650	1 812
Current expenditure	6 641	7 037	7 699	8 741	9 816	10 738	12 579	13 682	15 679	16 213
Purchase of goods and services	2 281	2 359	2 519	2 906	3 143	3 427	4 045	4 367	4 841	5 171
Defense	1 026	1 019	1 104	1 285	1 375	1 483	1 815	1 842	2 062	2 275
Civil	1 255	1 340	1 415	1 621	1 768	1 944	2 230	2 525	2 779	2 896
Subsidies	1 195	1 351	1 467	1 510	1 756	1 688	2 252	2 392	2 542	2 576
Interest	320	333	361	375	421	452	500	512	550	582
Current transfers	2 845	2 994	3 352	3 950	4 496	5 171	5 782	6 411	7 746	7 884
Net Current Savings	1 474	1 476	1 747	1 875	1 669	1 923	1 917	2 561	3 016	3 567
Depreciation and other operating provisions	49	58	62	69	74	80	89	99	108	120
Gross Savings	1 523	1 534	1 809	1 944	1 743	2 003	2 006	2 660	3 124	3 687
Gross fixed asset formation	366	403	411	493	568	679	742	808	970	1 029
Surplus on Current and Fixed Investment Account	1 157	1 131	1 398	1 451	1 175	1 324	1 264	1 852	2 154	2 658
Lending	1 003	974	1 269	1 321	1 049	1 217	1 173	1 761	2 040	2 509
Net capital transfers to others sectors	154	157	129	130	126	107	91	91	114	149

1 According to OECD definitions.
2 Provisional.
3 Approved budget.
Source: Norwegian submission to the OECD.

Table M **Monetary Survey**
Kr. million, end of period

		1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967[4]
THE BANK OF NORWAY :										
Assets:	Gold and net foreign assets	1 658	1 861	1 842	1 824	2 187	2 465	3 082	3 365	4 273
	Loans and advances	99	75	126	134	131	180	84	202	283
	Norwegian bonds	189	185	179	176	208	221	214	233	272
Liabilities:	Notes in circulation	3 675	3 823	4 043	4 187	4 517	4 756	5 118	5 501	5 918
	Government current account	2 089	1 980	1 816	1 534	1 544	1 395	1 281	1 069	1 676
	Other public accounts	606	655	670	775	762	779	769	778	837
	Commercial and savings banks	707	704	643	552	626	662	806	834	691
COMMERCIAL BANKS :										
Assets:	Cash	143	151	155	183	193	190	183	190	200
	Deposits, Bank of Norway	660	666	634	554	603	713	831	844	707
	Deposits, commercial bank	544	633	623	586	589	641	788	638	669
	Deposits, foreign banks[1]	784	917	847	782	916	970	1 550	1 218	1 429
	Domestic and foreign bonds[1]	632	650	682	683	781	1 021	1 187	1 347	1 704
	Domestic loans[1]	5 472	6 132	7 241	7 809	8 221	8 951	9 462	10 530[3]	11 313
Liabilities:	Domestic deposits	5 763	6 172	6 430	6 765	7 240	8 088	9 141	9 767	10 860
	Deposits from abroad[1]	321	413	290	290	412	404	409	418	438
NET STOCK OF FOREIGN EXCHANGE[2]		3 187	3 511	3 752	3 503	3 858	4 423	5 726	5 942	7 485

1 Some rearrangement of data from 1961 impedes comparison with earlier years (1959-1960).
2 In the Bank of Norway, commercial banks, shipping firms and insurance companies. Including IMF position and gold.
3 See note 3 to Table N.
4 Preliminary figures.

Source: Monthly Bulletin of Statistics, Central Bureau of Statistics.

Table N Credit Survey
Kr. million, end of period

	1959	1960	1961	1962	1963	1964	1965	1966	1967[4]
Domestic lending by financial institutions[1]:									
Bank of Norway	99	75	126	134	131	180	84	202	183
Commercial banks[2]	5 472	6 132	7 241	7 809	8 221	8 951	9 462	10 530[3]	11 313
Savings banks[2]	4 782	5 204	5 718	6 172	6 656	7 129	7 623	8 316[3]	9 080
State banks	6 224	6 728	7 329	7 924	8 628	9 376	10 215	10 962	12 021
Post Office Savings Bank	266	296	321	364	393	429	449	468	493
Life insurance companies	2 015	2 279	2 603	2 919	3 240	3 591	3 970	4 361	4 675
Loan associations, etc.	1 594	1 789	1 969	2 191	2 332	2 653	3 031	3 405	3 707
Total	20 452	22 503	25 307	27 521	29 601	32 309	34 834	38 244	41 572
Domestic lending by berrowing sector:									
Agriculture, forestry	1 958	2 146	2 348	2 391	2 569	2 719	2 889	3 062	
Fishing and whaling	404	390	440	553	528	539	477	573	
Mining and manufacturing	3 085	3 255	3 819	4 355	4 591	5 144	5 882	6 800	
Electricity, gas and water works	1 069	1 058	1 104	1 173	1 314	1 484	1 432	1 493	
Wholesale and retail trade	1 834	2 024	2 349	2 431	2 681	2 890	3 241	3 568	n.a.
Real estate and private consumers	9 244	10 444	11 218	12 222	13 379	14 644	16 170	17 717	
Shipping	1 610	1 961	2 224	2 351	2 221	2 215	2 335	2 481	
Other industries	954	1 136	1 225	1 359	1 554	1 695	2 015	2 137	
Total	20 158	22 414	24 727	26 837	28 837	31 340	34 441	37 831	

1 Including some lending to sectors not specified below.
2 Some rearrangement of data from 1961 and onwards impedes comparison with 1960.
3 A part of the increase from 1965 to 1966 is due to rearrangement of data to the net effect of Kr. 69 million for commercial and Kr. 2 million for savings banks (end of 1966).
4 Preliminary figures.

Source: Economic Bulletin, Bank of Norway and Monthly Bulletin of Statistics, Central Bureau of Statistics.

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